The First Indochina War

While the Nazis of Germany were busy capturing France back during World War II, France had begun to lose control of Vietnam. Japan took this opportunity to create a foothold within the country before taking it completely. The Japanese met resistance from the Viet Minh who quickly found support in other areas of the country. When Japan surrendered in 1945, the Viet Minh seized Hanoi and declared Vietnam as an independent country. Thus, the Democratic Republic of Vietnam was founded.

However, France did not accept this declaration of independence from the Viet Minh. They sent French forces to push the communist rebels back to the north. Ho Chi Minh requested help from America but it was engaged in the Cold War with Russia. America was uneasy about giving aid to the communists in Vietnam and supported France instead. The First Indochina War continued between Ho Chi Minh and France until the rebels won at Dien Bien Phu, which forced France to negotiate a treaty with them.